Differences in Inspired & Expired Air

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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Differences in Inspired & Expired Air: Extended

Extended Tier Only

Reason for Differences Between Inspired & Expired Air Table

GAS	INSPIRED AIR	EXPIRED AIR	REASON FOR DIFFERENCE
OXYGEN	21%	16%	OXYGEN IS REMOVED FROM BLOOD BY RESPIRING CELLS SO BLOOD RETURNING TO LUNGS HAS A LOWER OXYGEN CONCENTRATION THAN THE AIR IN THE ALVEOLI WHICH MEANS OXYGEN DIFFUSES INTO THE BLOOD IN THE LUNGS
CARBON DIOXIDE	0.04%	4%	CARBON DIOXIDE IS PRODUCED BY RESPIRATION AND DIFFUSES INTO BLOOD FROM RESPIRING CELLS; THE BLOOD TRANSPORTS THE CARBON DIOXIDE TO THE LUNGS WHERE IT DIFFUSES INTO THE ALVEOLI AS IT IN A HIGHER CONCENTRATION IN THE BLOOD THAN IN THE AIR IN THE ALVEOLI
WATER VAPOUR	LOWER	HIGHER	WATER EVAPORATES FROM THE MOIST LINING OF THE ALVEOLI INTO THE EXPIRED AIR AS A RESULT OF THE WARMTH OF THE BODY
NITROGEN	78%	78%	NITROGEN GAS IS VERY STABLE AND SO CANNOT BE USED BY THE BODY, FOR THIS REASON ITS CONCENTRATION DOES NOT CHANGE IN INSPIRED OR EXPIRED AIR

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